

CHILDREN'S APPERCEPTION TEST — HUMAN VERSION (CAT-H)

Psychodiagnostic Report — Bellak Analysis-Sheet Method

Instrument: The Children's Apperception Test — Human Version (CAT-H; Bellak & Bellak, 1965) **Interpretive system:** Bellak, L. & Abrams, D. M., *The T.A.T., the C.A.T., and the S.A.T. in Clinical Use* — the Bellak C.A.T. Blank & Analysis Sheet (10-variable scheme; descriptive interpretive diagnostic levels) **Cards administered:** Card 1 to Card 10 **Language of production:** Hinglish (transcribed verbatim by the examiner) **Patient:** AP, 16-year-old male adolescent

A NOTE ON METHOD (per the manual)

Bellak instructs the interpreter to read each story on three levels: the **descriptive** (what literally happens), the **interpretive** (a generalised conditional clause, usually framed as "*If one...*"), and the **diagnostic** (a definite statement about the person). The interpreter then condenses each record onto the Analysis Sheet's ten variables. Throughout, Bellak warns that fantasy material is "prima facie only the fantasy needs of the subject," that the relation of fantasy needs to behaviour must be checked against clinical/biographical data, and that single signs are never diagnostic in isolation — consistency *across* stories is what carries weight.

The CAT-H employs human figures in the same stimulus situations as the original animal C.A.T., designed for children and adolescents aged 7–10+ and those with higher intellectual functioning who respond more productively to human stimuli. The interpretation framework remains identical.

PART I — ANALYSIS SHEET, CARD BY CARD

Format follows the Bellak C.A.T. Blank / Analysis Sheet. A tick () marks the categories endorsed by the protocol.

CARD 1 — Children at a table with food; adult figure in background

1. Main theme - *Descriptive*: Three children and their father. The father, traumatised by his wife's death (she died while cooking), develops serious mental issues. He kills the children one by one and makes the surviving ones eat them. Initially there were 5–6 siblings. The child sitting in the corner escapes, calls the police, and saves himself. The father is arrested. - *Interpretive*: If one lives under a traumatised, violent authority figure, survival depends on being overlooked and marginalized; only external institutional help can provide rescue. - *Diagnostic*: Profound fear of a destructive, cannibalistic paternal figure. Oral-aggressive themes dominate. The family is perceived as a site of annihilation. Survival requires invisibility and external intervention — personal agency is insufficient.

2. Main hero () - a) Age: 6–8 years (corner child); father also nominated ~ b) Sex: male ~ c) Vocation: child/dependent - d) Abilities: escape, calling for help ~ e) Interests: survival ~ f) Traits: small, quiet, overlooked - g) Body/self-image: **vulnerable, threatened** — the body is conceived as potential food, an object to be consumed; survival depends on insignificance - h) Adequacy: **minimally adequate** — can only escape and call police; cannot actively fight or protect

3. Main needs and drives of hero - a) Behavioural needs: **n Harm Avoidance** (primary — escape/survival); **n Succorance** (seeking help from police). Father's needs: extreme **n Aggression, n Dominance** (absolute control through violence). *Dynamic inference*: the massive aggression attributed to the father likely represents projected aggressive impulses of the subject. - b) Figures/objects/circumstances introduced: **police** (external rescue — significant introduction); multiple siblings (5–6) systematically eliminated; **cannibalism** (children forced to eat siblings — highly significant oral-aggressive content); mother dying while cooking; trauma and mental illness as causal explanations; **movie reference** as distancing device. - c) Figures/objects/circumstances omitted: **no nurturing figure** after mother's death; no sibling alliance; no internal coping mechanism.

4. Conception of environment (world) as: extremely dangerous, violent, unpredictable. The home is a place of death. Authority figures are mentally unstable and destructive. No natural protection exists — safety requires external institutional intervention. Trauma begets endless cycles of violence.

5. Figures seen as - a) Parental figures: **father — traumatised, mentally ill, cannibalistic, murderous.** His aggression is attributed to trauma (wife's death) and anger issues. He is simultaneously provider and destroyer. **Mother — absent; died in the act of nurturing (cooking).** Idealised through absence. Her death catalyses father's deterioration. - b) Contemporary/sibling figures: **victims, helpless, consumed** by paternal aggression. - c) Authority figures: **police — only source of justice and rescue.** External, impersonal authority more trustworthy than family.

6. Significant conflicts: survival vs. annihilation; trust vs. fear of authority (the protector is the destroyer); oral incorporation vs. oral aggression (food = both nurturance and destruction); dependence vs. autonomy.

7. Nature of anxieties () - () **physical harm/annihilation** (primary, overwhelming) - () **being consumed/incorporated** (oral-cannibalistic) - () **loss of nurturing object** (mother's death) - () **helplessness/abandonment** (no reliable caretaker)

8. Main defenses against conflicts and fears () - () **Projection** — all aggression placed entirely in the father figure - () **Externalization** — solution comes from outside (police) - () **Rationalization** — father's behaviour explained through "trauma" and "mental issues" - () **Distancing** — story framed through movie reference ("maine esi movie dekhi thi") - () **Splitting** — clear good (children/police) vs. evil (father), no ambivalence

9. Adequacy of superego () - () Punishment is **proportionate** — father caught by police. However, punishment is external and imposed rather than self-generated. Father shows no remorse. Suggests a superego relying on **external enforcement** rather than internalized moral standards.

10. Integration of the ego () - a) Hero: minimally adequate (escapes only) - b) Outcome: **mixed** — child survives but siblings are dead; no restoration - c) Drive control: **poor** — aggressive content overwhelms the narrative - d) Thought processes: **structured, coherent, logically sequenced** (beginning/middle/end present); reality testing preserved (police intervention is realistic); however, oral-cannibalistic content indicates significant anxiety breakthrough - Intelligence: above average (elaborate story, causal reasoning) | Maturation level: regressed content despite adequate cognitive structure | Organic signs: none

CARD 2 — Three figures in a rope-pulling scene; one alone, two together

1. Main theme - *Descriptive*: Three siblings on a mountain — arrogant one (left), smart one (middle, main character), smaller innocent one (right). They play a life-or-death game: loser falls off the mountain. The smart middle child deliberately sacrifices himself to save both others, reasoning that his death would cause the "least loss" — he's neither the parents' favourite nor the best student. Parents cried "but not that much." The arrogant sibling reformed after witnessing the sacrifice. - *Interpretive*: If one is neither the favourite nor the achiever, one's life has least value; self-sacrifice becomes the only meaningful act for the invisible, unvalued child. - *Diagnostic*: Profound feelings of worthlessness, expendability, and being unvalued within the family. Self-sacrificial/**passive suicidal ideation** as response to perceived dispensability. Depressive cognitions about conditional parental love.

2. Main hero () - a) Age: 12 years ~ b) Sex: male ~ c) Vocation: student (middle child) - d) Abilities: intelligence, "smart," technique for saving others ~ e) Interests: being valued, mattering ~ f) Traits: wise, self-aware, self-sacrificing, invisible, unacknowledged - g) Body/self-image: **worthless, dispensable** — "mere marne se kam se kam loss hai" (my death causes the least loss). Self conceived as having the least value in the family hierarchy. Intelligence is present but unrecognised. - h) Adequacy: **paradoxically adequate** (saves others through technique/sacrifice) yet **profoundly inadequate** (cannot find a reason to live; adequacy is expressed only through self-destruction)

3. Main needs and drives of hero - a) Behavioural needs: **n Affiliation/Love** (primary, chronically unmet); **n Recognition** (thwarted — feels completely unacknowledged); **n Abasement/Self-Sacrifice** (aggression turned inward); **n Nurturance** toward siblings (saves them through death); **n Achievement** (blocked — others are better). *Dynamic inference*: massive retroflection — all anger at parents' favouritism is converted into self-directed destruction. The self-sacrifice is a hostile act wrapped in noble framing. - b) Introduced: **life-or-death competition** (significant); parental favouritism (younger = favourite, older = academically good); self-sacrifice as "logical" solution; parents' **minimal grief** ("roye bas thode time tak"); arrogant sibling's reformation. - c) Omitted: **any attempt to communicate feelings**; no adult intervention; no anger toward parents (aggression entirely turned inward); no alternative solution considered.

4. Conception of environment (world) as: a **competitive arena where worth is measured by tangible qualities** (academics, being youngest/cutest). Those without visible worth are expendable. Love is **conditional, hierarchical**. Death/sacrifice is the only act creating meaning for the unvalued self.

5. Figures seen as - a) Parental figures: **conditionally loving, favouritistic, largely indifferent** to middle child's existence and even death. They are unjust distributors of affection. Reaction: not anger, but acceptance and self-destruction. - b) Sibling figures: Younger = favourite, receives unconditional love by being young. Older/arrogant = academically excellent, redeemable. Self (middle) = invisible, unvalued, dispensable.

6. Significant conflicts: self-worth vs. perceived worthlessness; need for love vs. acceptance of rejection; aggression (toward parents) vs. self-directed destruction (retroflexion); life vs. death — existence itself conditional on "winning."

7. Nature of anxieties () - () **being unloved/unvalued** (primary) - () **insignificance** — not mattering to anyone - () **abandonment** — even in death parents don't fully mourn - () **competitive inadequacy** — compared and found wanting - () **existential** — questioning purpose of existence

8. Main defenses () - () **Turning against the self (retroflexion)** — all aggression directed inward as self-sacrifice - () **Rationalization** — "mere marne se loss kam hai" — logical justification for self-destruction - () **Reaction Formation** — hostility toward family converted to noble sacrifice - () **Intellectualization** — uses logic to arrive at self-destruction - () **Altruistic Surrender** — gives up life so "more valued" others can live - () **Denial** — denies anger; presents acceptance rather than rage

9. Adequacy of superego () - () **Extremely harsh, primitive superego.** The "crime" is merely existing without being exceptional — punishment is death. Massively disproportionate. No actual crime committed, yet death is the consequence. Consistent with **depressive dynamics and passive suicidal ideation.**

10. Integration of the ego () - a) Hero: paradoxically adequate (saves others) yet profoundly self-destructive - b) Outcome: **unhappy** — hero dies; others reformed but he is gone - c) Drive control: **poor** — ego overwhelmed by internalized aggression; "solution" is self-annihilation - d) Thought processes: **structured, coherent, highly elaborated** (detailed, emotionally invested); reality testing partially maintained (story internally consistent but the "logic" of self-sacrifice reveals depressive distortion) - Intelligence: above average | Maturation: depressive features markedly regressed | **CLINICAL FLAG: Passive suicidal ideation requiring immediate assessment**

CARD 3 — Adult authority figure seated; small child figure nearby

1. Main theme - *Descriptive*: Batman-like story. A busy father who cannot express love is suddenly shot and killed. The child inherits everything materially but is not happy. Eventually becomes good — helps others with money, supports people, lives a happy life. Father loved the child but could not express it; connection was never built. - *Interpretive*: If one's father is emotionally unavailable, his sudden loss leaves material abundance but emotional void. Healing comes through altruistic behaviour and connecting with others. - *Diagnostic*: Oedipal themes with emotional deprivation. Father "loves but cannot show it" = attempt to preserve idealised paternal image despite experienced neglect. Father's death by external agent may represent repressed hostile wishes. Resolution through generosity = reaction formation.

2. Main hero () - a) Age: child/adolescent ~ b) Sex: male ~ c) Vocation: inheritor - d) Abilities: resourcefulness, generosity ~ e) Interests: connection, helping others ~ f) Traits: initially deprived, then altruistic - g) Body/self-image: incomplete and unloved despite material sufficiency; transforms into generous, connected person - h) Adequacy: **initially inadequate** (passive, deprived); **adequate post-death** (uses resources positively)

3. Main needs and drives of hero - a) Behavioural needs: **n Affiliation/Love** (primary, chronically unmet from father); **n Nurturance** (giving to others — becomes the nurturing figure he never had); **n Achievement** (becomes good); **n Autonomy** (independence after death). *Dynamic inference*: the intensity of post-mortem altruism suggests reaction formation against angry/acquisitive impulses. - b) Introduced: **shooting/murder of father** (significant violent introduction); money as inadequate substitute for love; helping others as path to happiness; father's unexpressed love — "pyaar karta tha par bata nahi paya." - c) Omitted: **mother completely absent**; murderer unnamed/unknown (externalized aggression); no grief process; no friends/peers.

4. Conception of environment (world) as: dangerous (people get shot) but offering opportunities for redemption through service. Authority figures are well-intentioned but emotionally incompetent. Love must be actively created.

5. Figures seen as - a) Parental figures: **father — loving but emotionally blocked/unavailable**. Busy, unable to express. Ultimately killed. Tragic rather than villainous. Both idealized and experienced as neglectful. **Mother — completely absent** (notable omission). - b) "Someone" who shoots: anonymous aggressor = displaced hostile wish toward father. - c) Others who receive help: substitutes for the connection never received.

6. Significant conflicts: need for love vs. father's unavailability; gratitude for provision vs. anger at neglect; hostile wishes vs. guilt (father killed by "someone"); dependence vs. independence (freedom only after death).

7. Nature of anxieties () - () **emotional abandonment/neglect** (primary) - () **guilt** over hostile wishes toward father - () **loss anxiety** — sudden, violent, unprepared - () **fear of being emotionally stunted** like father

8. Main defenses () - () **Idealization** — father "loved but couldn't show" (preserves good object) - () **Projection of aggression** — someone else kills father - () **Reaction Formation** — anger at deprivation converted to generosity - () **Undoing** — helping others undoes guilt over hostile wishes - () **Sublimation** — unmet needs channeled into prosocial behaviour - () **Denial** — absence of grief; immediate pivot to "becoming good"

9. Adequacy of superego (): Moderate. Father's death externalized — child not punished since aggression sufficiently displaced. "Reward" (happy life) for goodness suggests moral universe where prosocial behaviour is reinforced. Lack of mourning = superego lacunae regarding hostile wish.

10. Integration of the ego () - a) Hero: adequate post-resolution - b) Outcome: **happy, realistic** (adaptive resolution through prosocial behaviour) - c) Drive control: adequate; affect managed through action - d) Thought processes: structured, logical, temporal progression present; Batman reference suggests reliance on cultural scripts to process complex emotions - Intelligence: above average | Maturation: adequate | Organic signs: none

CARD 4 — Adult figure (mother) carrying packages; child on bicycle

1. Main theme - *Descriptive*: A mother everyone thinks is irresponsible (dresses up, takes money, goes out) is actually buying things for her children. Only her children know the truth. She was a former model. The elder child eventually helps others understand. Everyone realises she was responsible all along; a monument is built in her honour. - *Interpretive*: If one is a devoted caretaker misunderstood by the world, truth eventually emerges through those who truly know you. - *Diagnostic*: Strong idealization of the maternal figure with need to defend her against criticism. Child becomes mother's advocate (parentification/role reversal). Former model identity suggests awareness of maternal narcissism reframed as devotion.

2. Main hero (): Mother (central) and Elder Child (active agent). Dual identification. Adequacy: mother adequate in behaviour but needs child to advocate; elder child adequate through truth-telling.

3. Main needs: n Nurturance (mother → children); n Recognition (mother needs to be seen truly); n Defendance (elder child protects reputation). Introduced: social judgment; monument (grandiose validation); elder child as advocate. Omitted: **father completely absent**; no maternal flaw acknowledged.

4. Conception of environment: judgmental, superficial — judges by appearances. Ultimately fair when truth emerges.

5. Figures seen as: Mother — idealized, selfless, devoted, misunderstood. Elder Child — parentified advocate. Society — judgmental but correctable. Father — absent (notable).

6. Significant conflicts: appearance vs. reality; social judgment vs. inner truth; child's need to protect parent vs. own needs.

7. Nature of anxieties: fear of social disapproval; fear of maternal loss; anxiety about defending good object.

8. Main defenses (): **Idealization** (no maternal flaws); **Splitting** (those who understand vs. don't); **Reaction Formation** (possible neglect reframed as devotion); **Denial** (no negative maternal quality); **Role Reversal** (child protects mother).

9. Adequacy of superego: Lenient — no wrongdoing, merely misunderstanding reversed. Monument = grandiose. Inability to tolerate maternal ambivalence.

10. Integration of the ego: Moderate-to-Good. Well-structured narrative with resolution. Concerning: extreme idealization; father absent; parentification; grandiose ending.

CARD 5 — Two children in a small bed in a dimly lit room

1. Main theme - *Descriptive*: Twin children (Jay and Vijay) with a perfect bond. Always together, perfect children. No problems. Parents proud. Everyone admires them. Relationship stays good into adulthood. - *Interpretive*: If one has a perfect relational bond, all problems become manageable. - *Diagnostic*: Compensatory wish-fulfillment fantasy — stark contrast to violence/rejection in other cards. Represents idealized solution to the loneliness and expendability expressed in Card 2. Simplicity and absence of conflict suggest avoidance/denial.

2. Main hero (): Both twins equally (dual identification). Idealized adequacy — never struggle. Self-image: the desired self — competent, bonded, admired, source of pride.

3. Main needs: n Affiliation (fully met); n Recognition (admired by all); n Play. Introduced: idealized relationship; parental pride. Omitted: **any conflict whatsoever**; real challenge; death/violence; individual identity.

4. Conception of environment: **benign, supportive, admiring** — complete contrast to other cards. Wish fulfillment.

5. Figures: Twin = perfect mirror. Parents = proud, tension-free. Society = admiring. No negative figures.

6. Conflicts: Minimal — this IS the defense. Underlying: merger vs. individuation; fantasy vs. reality.

7. Anxieties: Defended against — separation, loneliness, disappointment, conflict.

8. Main defenses (): **Wish Fulfillment** (entire story); **Idealization**; **Denial** (complete); **Reaction Formation** (peaceful vs. violent other cards); **Avoidance**; **Merger Fantasy**.

9. Superego: No crime, no punishment. Untested. May reflect overly rigid superego or ego ideal as constant reproach.

10. Ego integration: Appears good but is concerning — coherent but shallow, constricted, avoidant. The oscillation between catastrophic violence (Cards 1, 2) and utopian bliss (Card 5) = significant **splitting**.

CARD 6 — Dark shelter/tent-like space with trees; figures dimly seen; child in foreground

1. Main theme - *Descriptive*: Three siblings — two older responsible ones (Jay and Vijay) and a younger mischievous favourite. Parents tell older ones to look after youngest. Youngest's mischief leads all into jungle. They get lost, food/water runs out. Eldest saves them from kidnappers seeking ransom. Upon reunion, parents immediately hug youngest, ask only ONCE about older ones. Older children realize: "hume khud ke liye hi karna hai" (we have to do everything for ourselves). - *Interpretive*: If one is the responsible but unfavoured child, no amount of heroism earns love. Self-reliance is the only option. - *Diagnostic*: **Repetition and confirmation of Card 2's core wound**. Parentification without reciprocal love. Forced premature emotional self-sufficiency. The naming "Jay and Vijay" (same as Card 5 twins) shows how the idealized twinship is contaminated by painful reality.

2. Main hero (): Two older siblings (Jay and Vijay). Highly adequate in competence (saves everyone) but emotionally unfulfilled. **"Competent but unloved"** self-image. Forced into premature adulthood.

3. Main needs: n Nurturance (forced outward — must caretake); n Affiliation (unmet by parents); n Autonomy (forced — "khud ke liye karna hai"); n Achievement (rescues, navigates danger). Introduced: jungle; **kidnappers** (exploitative adults); **parental differential treatment at reunion** (father asking "only once" — highly significant); resource scarcity. Omitted: positive parental interaction with older children; acknowledgment of heroism; anger expressed to parents.

4. Conception of environment: unfair, exploitative, demanding. Parents biased. Outside world predatory. Only one's own competence is reliable.

5. Figures seen as: Parents — unfair, favouritistic; assign responsibility without reciprocity. Younger sibling — irresponsible, favoured regardless. Kidnappers — exploitative adults. Older siblings — responsible, heroic but abandoned.

6. Conflicts: caretaking obligation vs. need to be cared for; competence vs. recognition; anger vs. compliance; resentment vs. duty.

7. Anxieties: () being unloved despite doing everything right (primary); parentification; abandonment; exploitation.

8. Main defenses (): **Identification with caretaker role**; **Suppression** ("hum theek hai"); **Denial of anger**; **Intellectualization** (cold conclusion); **Passive Aggression** (detailed description of unfairness = indirect accusation).

9. Superego: Unjust representation. Younger commits "crime" (mischief danger) but receives only love. Older commit no crime but "punished" with neglect. Mirrors deeply felt sense that moral universe is unjust.

10. Ego integration: Moderate with depressive/resentful undertones. Highly coherent, emotionally rich. Repetition of Card 2 theme = perseveration on core wound. Forced autonomy with underlying hopelessness.

CLINICAL NOTE: Confirms core dynamic — AP experiences himself as the capable, responsible child whose efforts go unrecognised while a less-deserving sibling receives unconditional love. Likely reflects actual family dynamics.

CARD 7 — Threatening/grasping adult figure approaching a child; steaming kettle

1. Main theme - Descriptive: Evil mother wastes money on beauty/food while family is extremely poor. Kills submissive husband when he finally speaks up ("dominate kar raha tha"). Stores body. Kills and eats children. Children try to flee but cannot. Police get tips but arrive too late — she escapes. Child witnesses father's death, loves father, but repeats father's "mistake" (speaking up) and is killed. - *Interpretive:* If one has a narcissistic, devouring mother, she will consume everyone. Those who assert themselves are destroyed. Victimhood is transmitted intergenerationally. - *Diagnostic:* Extreme oral-aggressive devouring maternal imagery. Father's passivity and one moment of assertion = learned helplessness. Child repeating pattern = identification with victim and fatalistic belief that challenging authority = annihilation.

2. Main hero (): Mother stated as main character ("buri kahani"). Father and child are identification figures — the passive victims. Adequacy: mother terrifyingly adequate in destruction; victims completely inadequate. Any assertion = destruction.

3. Main needs: n Aggression (Mother — extreme); n Dominance (Mother); n Harm Avoidance (Father/Child — failed); n Abasement (Father — "dab ke rehta tha"). Introduced: **cannibalism** (SECOND card — highly significant repetition); domestic violence; body storage; beauty narcissism; **failed police**; intergenerational repetition. Omitted: nurturing maternal quality; successful escape; outside support; hope.

4. Conception of environment: terrifying, inescapable. Powerful destroy with impunity. Help always too late. Truth-telling = annihilation.

5. Figures: Mother (Evil) — devouring, narcissistic, omnipotent. Father — passive, dominated, destroyed for one assertion. Children — helpless, trapped, consumed. Police — always too late.

6. Conflicts: submission vs. assertion (speaking up = death); need for mother vs. terror of mother; self-preservation vs. helplessness; oral needs vs. oral aggression.

7. Anxieties: () devouring/engulfment (primary); annihilation; fear of assertion; claustrophobic entrapment; intergenerational repetition.

8. Main defenses (): **Splitting** (mother ALL bad); **Projection** (extreme aggression in maternal figure); **Identification with victim**; **Externalization** ("buri kahani" — distancing); **Helplessness as defense** (escape impossible, no need to try).

9. Superego: Absent/Failed. Criminal escapes. Victims punished for non-crimes. Assertion treated as crime deserving death. Profoundly unjust.

10. Ego integration: Poor. Coherent but overwhelmingly aggressive. Second cannibalism card = oral-aggressive fixation. No positive resolution. Assertion-death

link = deep inhibition. **CLINICAL FLAG: Repetition of cannibalistic themes; assertion equated with death.**

CARD 8 — Adult figures seated; one adult speaking to a child

1. Main theme - *Descriptive*: Good family — father, mother, child. Mother dies of cancer. Father remarries. Step-mother "Lucy" is abusive (pinches, scolds, restricts). Neighbours know but don't help. Relatives unaware (step-mother acts well in front of them). Child perseveres through study and hard work. Confronts step-mother ("takkar deke bahar nikal gaya"). Builds own life, marries, creates family, happy. Father eventually divorces step-mother after child reveals truth. - *Interpretive*: If one faces abuse from a replacement parent, one must rely on own strength. Others witness but won't intervene. Freedom comes through individual effort. - *Diagnostic*: Cinderella/persecuted child narrative. Biological mother idealised (blameless death). Step-mother = "bad mother" split. Father blind/ineffective. Self-reliance and confrontation represent healthiest adaptive fantasy in protocol.

2. Main hero (): The child. **Most adequate hero across all cards** — perseveres, works hard, confronts abuser, builds own life. Self-image: resilient, determined, "simple" but strong.

3. Main needs: n Autonomy (self-liberation); n Achievement (studies, career); n Counteraction (confrontation); n Affiliation (creates new family); n Harm Avoidance. Introduced: cancer; step-mother; daily abuse; community silence; divorce; "Lucy" (Western name = distancing). Omitted: anger toward father; grief for mother.

4. Conception of environment: initially nurturing but fragile; then abusive and indifferent. BUT contains opportunity for self-made success. Harsh but not inescapable.

5. Figures: Biological Mother — idealized, blameless. Step-Mother "Lucy" — abusive, narcissistic, territorial. Father — blind/ineffective. Neighbours — complicit through silence. Life Partner — redemptive.

6. Conflicts: need for maternal love vs. abusive figure; father's protection vs. blindness; compliance vs. fighting back; dependence vs. escape.

7. Anxieties: () replacement fear; invisible abuse; abandonment by protectors; entrapment; loss.

8. Main defenses (): **Splitting** (bio-mother all good, step-mother all bad); **Idealization**; **Counterphobic behaviour** (confronts abuser); **Sublimation** (channels suffering into work); **Distancing** (foreign name); **Delayed gratification**.

9. Superego: Proportionate and functional. Most balanced moral universe in protocol. Step-mother punished (divorce); child rewarded (happy life). When effective defenses mobilised, superego works adaptively.

10. Ego integration: BEST in protocol. Complete arc; personal agency; realistic coping; confrontation; mature defenses. **CLINICAL NOTE: Demonstrates latent capacity for healthy functioning — therapeutic goal**.

CARD 9 — Child in bed in dark room; open door to lit area

1. Main theme - *Descriptive*: Child's father works "out of station." Father only greets child in morning, leaves him with a careless servant. Servant neglects child for personal work. Snake enters room. Child falls from bed. Just as snake is about to bite, father returns and saves him. Father fires servant, becomes dedicated present parent. Story ends with father-child bonding moments. - *Interpretive*: If left with unreliable substitutes, danger arises. Only the biological parent can truly protect. Crisis makes absent father realise the child's need. - *Diagnostic*: Wish-fulfillment rescue fantasy. Absent/busy father returns as savior and transforms. Snake = danger of parental absence. Servant = inadequate substitute. Deep wish for paternal attention and the fantasy that crisis forces father to change.

2. Main hero (): Father explicitly stated as "hero of the story." Child is emotional identification figure. Father transforms from absent to heroic to devoted. Child entirely passive.

3. Main needs: n Succorance (child: protection from father); n Nurturance (father, wished-for); n Harm Avoidance (child: passive); n Dominance (father: takes control). Introduced: **snake** (significant threat); careless servant; "out of station"; morning-only contact; father's intuition; firing servant; bonding montage. Omitted: **mother completely absent**; self-protective capacity; anger toward father.

4. Conception of environment: dangerous when unprotected — threats emerge without reliable care. Substitutes unreliable. BUT contains possibility of rescue and reform. More hopeful than most cards.

5. Figures: Father — absent but caring; heroic when present; capable of transformation. Servant — careless, self-interested. Snake — external threat emerging in absence of protection. Mother — completely absent.

6. Conflicts: father's presence vs. absence; trust vs. unreliability; passivity vs. need for protection.

7. Anxieties: () abandonment/neglect; physical danger; separation; being forgotten; helplessness.

8. Main defenses (): **Wish Fulfillment** (father becomes devoted); **Idealization** (father has intuition); **Denial of anger** (no anger at father); **Regression** (passive); **Rescue Fantasy** (core).

9. Superego: Proportionate. Servant punished (fired). Father's "crime" (absence) punished through scare. Natural consequences.

10. Ego integration: Moderate with wish-fulfillment. Coherent, logical. Positive imagery possible. But: hero entirely passive; deus ex machina; mother absent; magical transformation.

CARD 10 — Child across adult's lap; bathroom/washroom setting

1. Main theme - *Descriptive*: Parents (love marriage, rejected by family, live alone) have a child who is "evil minded" from birth. Despite mother's best efforts, child is violent from early childhood (hits until bleeding). Progressively worse — reveals "evil face," imprisons parents, forces them to work for his gambling/drugs. Family member discovers, frees parents; police arrest child. Parents were "bohat innocent," covered up behaviour. They feel regret. Ending not happy. - *Interpretive*: If one produces an inherently evil child, no love can change innate destructiveness. Isolation from extended family removes protective structures. - *Diagnostic*: "Evil child" may represent AP's projected aggressive impulses — the feared destructive part of self. Parents' helplessness = good objects destroyed by bad internal object. Imprisonment of parents = reversal of felt powerlessness. Extended family as rescuer = desire for broader support.

2. Main hero (): Mother-Father stated as main characters. Evil child = anti-hero, possibly projection of subject's feared aggressive self. Parents completely inadequate — goodness becomes vulnerability.

3. Main needs: n Aggression (evil child: innate, escalating); n Dominance (evil child: reverses power); n Nurturance (mother: failed); n Affiliation (parents' bond); n Succorance (parents: eventual family help). Introduced: **love marriage/family rejection**; innate evil from birth; progressive violence; blood; **imprisonment of parents**; gambling/drugs; extended family rescue; parental regret. Omitted: professional help; child redemption; any positive child quality.

4. Conception of environment: innate evil cannot be reformed through love. Isolation removes protection. Eventually helpful but late. Fatalistic view of nature.

5. Figures: Parents — loving, innocent, helpless; goodness = vulnerability. Evil Child — born bad, irredeemable. Extended Family — initially rejecting, ultimately saving. Police — effective.

6. Conflicts: nurture vs. nature; autonomy vs. support; love vs. helplessness; free will vs. determinism.

7. Anxieties: () fear of own innate "badness"; losing control; isolation; irredeemability; parental disappointment.

8. Main defenses (): **Projection** (aggression onto evil child); **Splitting** (parents ALL good, child ALL bad); **Externalization** (evil is innate); **Reversal** (child over parents = wished power); **Denial** (parents cover behaviour).

9. Superego: Functional, somewhat harsh. Child arrested. "Not happy" ending = damage cannot be undone. No internal reform — child shows no remorse.

10. Ego integration: Moderate with concerning content. Complex multi-stage narrative; cause-effect; realistic resolution. But: innate evil = fatalism/self-fear; power reversal themes; drugs/gambling. **CLINICAL NOTE: "Evil from birth" concept may reflect anxiety about own aggressive impulses being innate/uncontrollable.**

PART II — SUMMARY AND FINAL REPORT

A. CROSS-CARD PATTERN SUMMARY

Variable	Consistent Pattern
Main heroes	Predominantly child figures: deprived, unrecognised, endangered. Adequacy ranges from helpless victim (1, 2, 7) to resilient overcomer (8).
Main needs	n Affiliation/Love (unmet — all cards); n Harm Avoidance (8/10); n Succorance (7/10); n Aggression (6/10, projected)
Main presses	p Aggression-physical (8/10); p Rejection (7/10); p Loss (6/10); p Dominance (6/10)
Conception of world	Predominantly dangerous, exploitative, emotionally depriving. Home = site of violence/neglect (not safety)
Parental figures	Fathers: violent (1), absent (3, 9), blind (6, 8), submissive (7). Mothers: dead (1, 8), idealised (4), demonised (7), absent (3, 5, 6, 9). No card shows both parents simultaneously present, protective, and emotionally available.
Conflicts	Need for love vs. rejection; aggression vs. self-destruction; competence vs. recognition; assertion vs. annihilation; dependence vs. forced autonomy
Anxieties	Annihilation, devouring, abandonment, being unloved, insignificance, existential worthlessness
Main defenses	Splitting (pervasive); Projection (very high); Idealization (high); Denial (high); Turning against self (moderate); Sublimation (low — Card 8 only)
Superego	Inconsistent and externally dependent: sometimes extremely harsh (Card 2: death for being "not enough"), sometimes absent (Card 7: evil escapes). Justice delivered by external authority (police), not internalized.
Ego integration	Variable: cognitive functioning intact throughout (coherent narratives, logical structure); affective functioning compromised (overwhelmed by aggressive/depressive content). Best functioning in Card 8 (healthy defenses available).

B. DIAGNOSTIC FORMULATION

The index patient, AP, a 16-year-old male adolescent, presents a CAT-H profile characterised by significant personality disturbance centred around themes of emotional deprivation, parental inadequacy, sibling-based worthlessness, and pervasive aggressive content with inadequate containment.

The core psychological constellation centres on **a deep sense of being invisible, unvalued, and expendable within the family system** — particularly in contrast to a favoured younger sibling and an academically superior older sibling. This perceived worthlessness has generated:

1. **Significant depressive ideation including passive suicidal themes** (Card 2: self-sacrifice as "logical" for someone whose death causes "least loss")
2. **Massive aggressive fantasy projected onto parental figures** (Cards 1, 7: cannibalistic/murderous parents)
3. **Pre-oedipal level object relations** (pervasive splitting, part-object relating, no good-enough parental object)
4. **Disorganised attachment pattern** (no secure base; caregivers dangerous/unreliable; forced self-reliance)
5. **Parentification without reciprocal love** (Cards 4, 6, 8: child protects/parents younger but receives no recognition)
6. **Severe inhibition of self-expression** (Card 7: speaking up = death; protocol-wide suppression of anger toward parents)
7. **Latent ego resources** (Card 8: capacity for perseverance, confrontation, sublimation exists but is not habitually mobilised)

The ego, while cognitively intact with preserved reality testing and above-average intellectual functioning, is overwhelmed by primitive aggressive and depressive content and relies predominantly on immature defense mechanisms. Object relations are at a pre-oedipal level. The patient appears psychologically conflicted and emotionally distressed but not disorganised, with preserved reality orientation and latent therapeutic potential demonstrated in Card 8.

C. CLINICAL RECOMMENDATIONS

1. **Immediate:** Formal suicidal ideation assessment based on Card 2 (passive suicidal themes).
 2. **Family dynamics exploration:** Actual parental favouritism, sibling differential treatment, emotional availability.
 3. **Individual therapy focus:** Self-worth, emotional expression, anger acknowledgment, strengthening mature defenses.
 4. **Domestic environment screening:** Card 7's violence content warrants exploration of witnessed/experienced violence.
 5. **Attachment-focused work:** Addressing early disruption; building secure relational capacity.
-

Report prepared following the Bellak Analysis-Sheet Method (Leopold Bellak, M.D., 5th Edition) with Murray's Need-Press Framework. Format modelled on the Psychodiagnostic Cases Submission, MAN College of Special Education and Psychological Studies.